not make up for the paucity of well-trained diplomats. Opening the doors for such induction would only open doors for patronage politics polluting the purity of a highly admired professional service. While opposing experts from other fields being assigned diplomatic tasks, Indian Foreign Service officers often favour training of their own in a broader range of technical skills from energy issues to cultural diplomacy.

In an effort to bring fresh blood into the Ministry of External Affairs, the Modi administration is encouraging lateral entry. In a deposition before a parliamentary committee in 2015, Foreign Secretary Jaishankar stated that the MEA would fill positions in its Policy Planning Division by recruiting from outside the government.[46]

It is unlikely, however, that the Modi government will revert to appointing too many outside candidates in senior diplomatic positions. The ambition of every foreign service officer is to rise to the position of ambassador, and most capable officers manage to fulfil that ambition in India's case. To ensure that it continues to attract talent and that entrants believe they will all one day become ambassadors there is an internal reluctance to either recruit too many candidates or appoint non-career diplomats as ambassadors. Unlike several countries, India tends to limit the number of political appointees it sends as ambassadors. The vast majority of Indian ambassadors are career diplomats. The only exception until recently were ambassadorial appointments in the US, the UK and the Soviet Union, which were offered to ruling party politicians. In recent years that has changed, opening these previously 'political' positions for career diplomats.

In the first few decades after Independence the people who joined the services, especially the Indian Foreign Service, were driven either by their passion for foreign service or a desire to follow parents who had served in the civil service under the British. The Indian Foreign Service was considered a more exclusive service as those ranking highest in the competitive examination were selected for foreign service. K. Shankar